UNIVERSITY OF MINNESOTA

*IDSC 4101*

# Generative and Agentic AI for Business

A 2-credit upper-division course for all business majors

No coding required · 7 weeks · 14 sessions · Project-based capstone

*[Your Name] · Carlson School of Management · [Semester Year]*

# The Gap We're Filling

Business graduates are already using AI — but most lack the vocabulary and judgment to lead with it.

## What students typically have

- ✓ Experience using a chatbot interface
- ✗ Understanding of why AI behaves as it does
- ✗ Ability to spot automation opportunities
- ✗ Vocabulary to evaluate vendor claims
- ✗ Awareness of responsible AI risks

## What this course delivers

- ✓ Builder + ideation mindset
- ✓ Hands-on tool fluency (no coding)
- ✓ Workflow automation skills
- ✓ Agentic AI literacy
- ✓ Responsible AI judgment

*No peer program currently offers a no-code agentic AI course combining conceptual depth + hands-on fluency.*

# What Makes IDSC 4101 Different

| Most AI courses for business | IDSC 4101 |
| --- | --- |
| Prompt engineering focus only | Builder + ideation mindset throughout |
| Lecture and case study only | Build sprints every other week |
| No hands-on tool time | Students build automations and agents in class |
| Ethics as a standalone week | Responsible AI woven across all 7 weeks |
| One-shot final presentation | AI Innovation Showcase with external guests |

# The 7-Week Arc

**Wks 1–2**
Foundations & Personal AI

Gemini · NotebookLM
Prompt strategy
Personal productivity

**Wks 3–4**
Team Workflows & Biz Apps

Zapier / Make
Business function apps
Midterm exam

**Wks 5–6**
Agentic AI & Product Thinking

n8n · Voiceflow
Agent blueprints
Build sprint #2

**Wk 7**
Strategy, Ethics & Showcase

AI strategy frames
Responsible AI session
Capstone pitches

**Personal → Team → Agentic → Strategic**

14 sessions · 3 Build Sprints · 4 Reflection Posts · Midterm + Final Exam · Team Capstone Pitch

# Tools Students Use — No Coding Required

## Conversational AI & Research

Google Gemini
NotebookLM
Google AI Studio

**Weeks 1–3**

## No-Code Automation

Zapier / Make
Relevance AI

**Weeks 3–5**

## Agentic AI Platforms

n8n
Voiceflow

**Weeks 5–6**

*All platforms have free tiers sufficient for coursework. Tool categories are durable — specific platforms can be swapped as the landscape evolves.*

# Assessment: Hybrid Model

| | |
|---|---|
| **20%** | **Reflection Posts ×4**<br>Individual · 200–300 words · Bi-weekly · Personal observations |
| **25%** | **Midterm Conceptual Exam**<br>Take-home · Open-note · Case-based · No coding |
| **25%** | **Final Conceptual Exam**<br>Take-home · Open-note · Integrative cases · Strategy + ethics |
| **25%** | **AI Innovation Showcase**<br>Team pitch · No prototype · External guests · Trade show format |
| **10%** | **Participation + Build Sprints**<br>In-class builds (Wk 3 + Wk 5) · Engagement · Attendance |

# The AI Innovation Showcase

*Week 7 · Trade show format · External guests*

Teams design an AI-assisted solution to a real business problem — no working prototype required. External practitioners rotate through team stations, ask structured questions, and give real feedback.

| Wk 4 | Wk 5 S1 | Wk 5 S2 | Wk 7 S1 | Wk 7 S2 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Teams form + problem statement | Solution design sketch | Peer pitch practice | Slide deck submitted | AI Innovation Showcase |

*Rubric: Problem clarity · Solution design · Business value · Responsible AI awareness · Pitch quality*

*"The hardest part of any AI project is defining the problem and designing the solution clearly — that's exactly what this format tests, and what employers are hiring for."*

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# Ready to Launch

- Full 7-week syllabus with session-level detail — complete
- Hybrid model: 2 conceptual exams + capstone pitch + 4 reflection posts
- No coding — accessible to all business concentrations
- All tools have free student tiers; AI Studio coordinated with IT
- AI Innovation Showcase creates a high-visibility department event
- Fills a genuine whitespace: no comparable course at peer institutions

**Seeking department support to offer IDSC 4101 in [Semester Year].**